



MONTHLY UPDATE

DR Congo: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-06 · 25 systems and instruments tracked, 14 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-06 — July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

An interministerial order pricing digital-sector duties, taxes and fees took effect on signature on 20 July 2026 and was suspended by government communiqué on 3 August.

Two strategic documents reached validation without adoption: the national AI strategy on 27 July, subject to amendments, and the sectoral digital economy policy 2026-2030 on 22 July, subject to completing its costing and indicators. The backbone's own numbers reached the Council of Ministers on 3 August: 7,000 km deployed against more than 18,500 km.

Infrastructure

Deployment of the transformation project's fibre backbone was reported to the 95th ordinary Council meeting on 3 August: 7,000 km laid against more than 18,500 km, leaving 11,500 km outstanding and tied to connecting 145 territories by 2030. The minister attributed the pace to budget constraints and a low disbursement rate on external financing, which he put down to donor procedure.

On 29 July the digital economy minister named a sovereign government cloud among the ministry's projects to be ordered and made executable, alongside the digital and data strategies, the identity platform and a certification authority. No hosting location, operator, procurement or budget line was stated. The following day a workshop named a national cybersecurity agency as one of five bodies whose roles in the incident-notification chain must be clarified, explicitly without creating new institutions; no creating instrument, budget line or head is held.

An operator launched a subscriber-level child filtering service on 17 July from 50 units for 30 days — a commercial service, not a state measure, with no subscriber figure. A data-centre group lifted committed capital from US\$350m to US\$380m across six markets, none of it allocated to DR Congo in the source.

Digital public infrastructure

A sector chief in Walikale told the provincial interior division on 23 July that his civil-status office had [no birth registers for several months and had stopped registering newborns](#); the province promised resupply with no date, and the stated consequences are exclusion from school enrolment and from proof of nationality. The same day, Kinshasa urban administration agents demonstrated over [two months of unpaid salary, with beneficiary listings already transmitted to the paying bank](#) and neither bank staff nor payroll agents attending the appointed payment.

Business formalisation was inspected on 28 July: the portal proposes a legal form and tracks a file in real time and the application [issues sole-trader attestations in under 48 hours, while full online company creation is not possible](#). A seminar opened on 15 July on a [public-enterprise digitalisation plan for 2026-2028](#) covering transaction traceability, automated validation circuits and data reconciliation, with no system, budget line or deployment date named.

In payments, a card-network executive confirmed on 2 July a [live use case settling mobile-wallet top-ups in stablecoins in the background](#), bypassing correspondent banking. On 14 July a card network and a domestic payments company announced [prepaid card issuance](#), the domestic partner serving more than three million customers through 4,000 agents. On 29 July a [national electronic certification authority was named, not established](#); the July order already prices qualified trust services at US\$30,000 foreign and US\$10,000 local.

Governance and regulation

The [interministerial order on digital-sector duties, taxes and fees was in force on signature on 20 July under its article 5](#). It sets a two-tier dollar schedule keyed to whether a provider is judged dominant, running from US\$2,500 to US\$15,000 for cloud services and US\$25,000 to US\$100,000 for data-centre declaration, with one startup line at US\$100. It was [suspended by government communiqué on 3 August](#). Neither the gazetted order nor the suspending communiqué is held.

Experts validated the [sectoral digital economy policy 2026-2030 on 21 and 22 July, subject to completing the costing, indicators and institutional responsibilities](#). A restitution workshop on 29 and 30 July presented a ten-dimension maturity diagnostic and named the [instruments to be articulated: the digital and data strategies, the AI strategy, the identity platform, the sovereign cloud, a certification authority and a cybersecurity agency](#), plus a rule that no AI platform be deployed without data quality, auditability and human supervision.

Two regulators agreed on 22 July to [form joint inspection teams and enforce local-content subcontracting rules on large operators](#), with scope beyond telecoms to digital services and electronic commerce; no written protocol is held. The same day the telecommunications regulator set a [binding escalation path for consumer complaints: the operator first, up to 30 working days, then referral to the regulator](#).

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

A stakeholder workshop of 23 to 27 July in Kinshasa [validated the draft national artificial intelligence strategy subject to amendments](#), on four pillars aligned to the national development plan on a 2030 horizon. No adoption date was established and the text is not held. At the same series of sessions officials went on record that bodies already acting across digital, research, data, cybersecurity and regulation have [roles not yet sufficiently articulated in a common steering architecture](#).

A government communiqué of 3 August confirmed that the [Startup Act implementing texts remain in preparation](#): four draft decrees adopted in May 2025 to operationalise the fiscal, customs and exchange advantages of the 2022 ordinance-law, none in force fifteen months on. None of the four texts is held.

On 3 July a memorandum was signed with a Chinese supplier for a [2,100 km route – 1,700 km along the Congo River plus nearly 400 km terrestrial](#) – at a stated US\$1.5bn, with more than US\$400m required for the first phase. Both figures are company-reported, and there is no financing close, contract or works.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

A development fund committed [US\\$32.8m into an upsized US\\$179m senior secured facility on 5 August](#), funding 728 new passive towers to take the network to 1,800, 70% of them rural, with solar and battery upgrades. The same lender committed US\$30m to the same borrower in 2023, when the network stood at 1,072 active towers.

On 23 July a state bank and the payroll monitoring committee settled the technical and organisational terms for [paying civil servants in rural territories, scoped to three named territories and others where no other bank operates](#). August 2026 was named as a target, with the bank's director-general calling a fixed date premature and the state contract unsigned.

The employment office launched a [portal and mobile application in July](#) on which jobseekers register skills and employers post needs, intended to build a national skills database. It was externally financed, and no user or placement figure is held.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.